Care Home Finance: Why Charge Counts and Financing Events Tell Different Stories

A reproducible comparison of registered charges, financing events and borrowing companies in England and Wales.

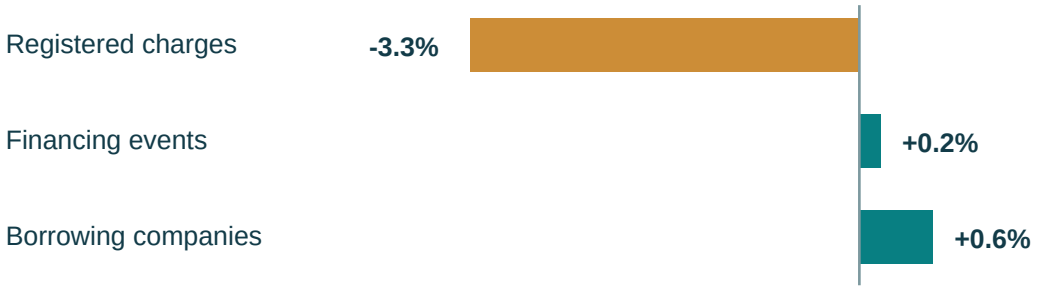
Matt Lenzie | Care Homes Finance
3 November 2026 | CHF-2026-R01 | Version 1.0

One market, three measures

In the first half of 2026, the published care-home cohort recorded 1,138 charges, 552 financing events and 802 borrowing companies. Against the same six months in 2025, charges fell by 3.3%, events rose by 0.2% and companies rose by 0.6%. A headline based only on filings would therefore describe a decline where the event measure was broadly unchanged.

This note adds a consistent comparison of all three measures and the number of charge filings per event to the Care Home Finance Report 2026 activity table. It is a secondary analysis of that report, not a separate survey or an independent verification of the underlying company filings.

H1 2026 change from H1 2025 (%)



Source: Care Homes Finance, seven-row lending-activity table. Changes calculated as (later / earlier - 1) x 100. Chart displays rounded values.

These are counts of recorded activity. They do not measure pounds lent, lending appetite, approval rates, pricing or the amount of capital available to an individual operator.

The complete-period comparison

The seven published rows allow three like-for-like comparisons: 2023 with 2025, H1 2025 with H1 2026, and January to August 2025 with the corresponding eight months of 2026. The two-year annual change is cumulative, not an annual growth rate.

Period	Charges	Financing events	Borrowing companies
2023	2036	914	1244
2024	2325	1085	1462
2025	2399	1136	1611
H1 2025	1177	551	797
H1 2026	1138	552	802
Jan to Aug 2025	1540	735	1043
Jan to Aug 2026	1574	763	1047

Comparison	Charges	Events	Companies
2023 to 2025	+17.8%	+24.3%	+29.5%
H1 2025 to H1 2026	-3.3%	+0.2%	+0.6%
Jan to Aug 2025 to Jan to Aug 2026	+2.2%	+3.8%	+0.4%

From 2023 to 2025, events rose 24.3%, compared with 17.8% for charges and 29.5% for borrowing companies. By January to August 2026, events were 3.8% above the matched 2025 window, while charges were 2.2% higher and companies 0.4% higher. The measures agree on the direction of that eight-month comparison but differ in scale.

The January to August and H1 windows overlap. Their counts must not be added together, and eight-month totals must not be compared with a full calendar year. September 2026 is excluded because the source treats charges as complete only to 31 August.

Fewer filings for each recorded event

Dividing charges by financing events provides a check on filing intensity. In H1 2025 there were 2.136 charges for every recorded event; in H1 2026 there were 2.062. This ratio is calculated from aggregate totals. It does not mean that each facility had that many charges, or establish the distribution across facilities.

Period	Charges per event
2023	2.228
2024	2.143
2025	2.112
H1 2025	2.136
H1 2026	2.062
Jan to Aug 2025	2.095
Jan to Aug 2026	2.063

The identity charges = events x charges per event explains how an almost unchanged event count can coexist with a lower filing count. It does not establish why filing intensity changed. The aggregate extract cannot distinguish changes in transaction structure, group organisation, security documentation or the composition of borrowers.

What an event represents

The source groups distinct combinations of lender, charge creation date and the borrower's registered postcode. That collapses multiple filings which may relate to one facility. It can also split a single facility across group addresses or combine separate deals sharing the grouping keys. The resulting count is an approximation of facilities, not a count of confirmed loan agreements.

Borrowing companies are a third unit: several companies can participate in one financing arrangement, and a company can appear in more than one event. Neither the company count nor the event count is a count of individual care homes. The parent report methodology defines the cohort and grouping rules.

How to use the findings

For an activity summary, report the event count alongside filings and borrowing companies, name the period, and retain the event definition. The H1 comparison supports a narrow statement: event activity in this observed cohort was broadly level. It cannot establish whether the same operators borrowed, whether new entrants obtained credit, or whether rates and credit terms improved.

The parent report refinancing section considers another question: the relationship between new charges and releases. Those charge-level findings should not be treated as an event-level explanation for the changes in this note. All analyses share the same Care Homes Finance source programme.

Evidence and reproduction

The accompanying package contains the unaltered lending-activity.csv extract, comparisons.csv, filing-intensity.csv, findings.json, a data dictionary, source manifest and reproduce.py. Running python3 reproduce.py regenerates the nine comparisons and seven ratios with no third-party Python dependency. Input and output files are recorded in SHA256SUMS.txt.

Download the files from the Care Homes Finance research repository, in the CHF-2026-R01 folder. The repository is maintained by the same publisher as this note.

The extract contains seven published aggregate rows, not the underlying Companies House microdata. Calculations from those totals are reproducible; the original company matching, charge selection and event deduplication are not independently reproducible from this package. No additional microdata or transaction validation is claimed.

Sources, dates and commercial interest

Source: Care Home Finance Report 2026, published 3 November 2026. Companies House snapshot: 1 October 2026; charges complete to 31 August 2026. CQC register: 3 June 2026. Lending coverage is England and Wales; the CQC itself covers England only. The supplied source credits Care Quality Commission, HSCA Active Locations, under Open Government Licence v3.0, and the Companies House charges register and company data. Original source rights are retained; this note does not assign a new blanket licence to the supplied data.

This is self-published research by Matt Lenzie for Care Homes Finance. It has not been represented as peer reviewed. Care Homes Finance is a trading name of Lenzie Consulting Ltd and has a commercial interest in arranging finance. It is a finance arranger and introducer, not a lender. This note is descriptive research and does not provide financial, legal or tax advice.

Contact for corrections or questions: enquiries@carehomesfinance.co.uk. Author and business background: Care Homes Finance about page.